

Bates Brewing Company

Asheville, North Carolina · Established 1923

2026 Competition Entry

Great American Beer Festival (GABF) 2026 — Submission Spec Sheet

Category: Imperial Stout (Flagship). Entry deadline: Friday, June 5, 2026 (EOD Mountain).

Field	Value
Brewery	Bates Brewing Company
Entry Name	Imperial Stout (Flagship)
Batch ID	BBC-2026-007
ABV	8.4%
IBU	65
Volume	24 bbl
Aging	14 months in second-use bourbon barrels
Yeast	in-house Bates-1923
Status	competition_entry
Submission Form	GABF 2026 Imperial Stout category

Sensory Profile

Pour: dense, mahogany-bordered black with a slow tan head. Aroma: bourbon, vanilla, dark chocolate, ripe plum. Palate: layered roast, oak tannin, light brown sugar sweetness, warm finish balanced by IBU 65. Mouthfeel: full, viscous, lightly carbonated.

Provenance Notes

Barrel program: 14-month aging in second-use Heaven Hill bourbon barrels sourced through Asheville Cooperage. Base malt: locally-sourced specialty malting barley (Caldwell Farms, Buncombe County). Yeast: in-house Bates-1923 strain, third-generation propagation.

Process Summary

Mash: 154°F single infusion, 75 minute rest. Boil: 90 minutes. Hops: bittering addition Magnum at 60 minutes, late charge Willamette at 10 minutes. Primary fermentation: 14 days at 65°F, in-house Bates-1923. Secondary: barrel-aged 14 months. Conditioning: 21 days post-blend.

Recipe Lineage

Lineage: descended from Thomas Bates's 1987 stout recipe; ABV target raised from 7.2% (1987) to 8.4% (2026 release) over three iterations. Yeast strain Bates-1923 maintained continuously since first propagation. Locally-malted barley share trending toward 100% by 2027 expression.

Competition Lineage

Prior GABF entries: 2024 (Imperial Stout, bronze), 2025 (Imperial Stout, honourable mention). 2026 release is the first batch under the extended 14-month barrel program.

Quality Attestation

All numbers on this sheet are drawn from the brewery production tracker snapshot as of 2026-05-30. Subsequent updates supersede this spec sheet; the production tracker is the authoritative source of record.

Prepared by Larry Bates, Head Brewer. Reviewed by Greg Holloway, Assistant Brewer.

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